ORBIT DIGITAL · BUSINESS GUIDE 2026

EV Charging Station Business in India

How to apply for subsidies, ideal locations, real investment & profit numbers, payments — all in one clear guide. Honest numbers, no hype.

~29,000 Charging stations in India today	**~13 lakh** Stations needed by 2030	**30%** Govt EV target by 2030

Created by **@santoshyelishala** | AI tools · Business ideas · Online earning
Business enquiries: help.orbitdigital@gmail.com

0 Why this opportunity now?

Every month India sees huge demand building up, but supply is lagging far behind. That gap is the business opportunity.

India today has roughly **29,000 public charging stations**. But by 2030, an estimated **~13 lakh (1.3 million) stations** will be needed — a gap of **over 12 lakh stations** in the next 4–5 years. The government target: **30% of vehicles electric by 2030**. EV sales are growing strongly every month, but charging infrastructure hasn't kept pace.

> **Reality check (honestly)**
> This is not a "guaranteed easy money" business. It is a **location-driven infrastructure business** — the right spot with the right model gives solid returns, but a charger in the wrong location is a dead investment. This guide gives you real numbers without over-promising.

1 Investment: what does it really cost?

Investment varies by charger type. There are two main types:

Charger type	Investment (approx)	Best for	Charge time
AC (slow)	**₹50,000 – ₹4 lakh**	Apartments, offices, shops, malls (long parking)	4–8 hrs
DC fast	**₹10 – ₹25 lakh**	Highways, petrol pumps, high-traffic spots	45–60 min

What's included in a DC fast station?

- **Charger hardware (EVSE):** ₹6–15 lakh (BIS-certified, CCS2 connector)
- **DISCOM connection + transformer:** ₹2–5 lakh (most people miss this — start early, it takes 4–12 weeks)
- **Civil work (foundation, canopy, CCTV, lighting):** ₹1–3 lakh
- **Software / CMS + payment integration:** ₹50k – ₹1.5 lakh

> **Money-saving tip**
> If you **lease** the land (instead of buying it), offer the landowner a **revenue-share instead of fixed rent** — it reduces your upfront burden, and gives the owner an incentive to keep the station running well.

2 How to apply for subsidy (the correct way)

> **Important — this is where most people get it wrong**
> The "up to 80% subsidy" figures under PM E-DRIVE apply only to **government entities, PSUs, and CPSEs** (govt offices, railways, NHAI toll plazas, oil company outlets) — routed through nodal agencies.

A **private individual cannot directly claim the PM E-DRIVE charging subsidy.** So if anyone tells you "PM E-Drive gives me 80% subsidy," that does not apply to an individual station.

REAL subsidy routes for a private entrepreneur:

Route	Benefit	How
State capital subsidy	**20–25% typical (Gujarat up to ₹10 lakh)**	Check your state EV policy. Apply to the state nodal agency once the station is live.
Bank financing (SBI EV Mitra etc.)	**Up to 80% of project value as a loan**	SBI EV Mitra scheme via CPO tie-ups like Statiq — ideal if you have land but limited cash.
Concessional EV tariff	**Electricity ₹5–6.5/unit (lower than normal commercial)**	Ask your DISCOM for an **"EV tariff category"** connection — this dramatically lowers your running cost.
GST / duty benefits	**GST relief on chargers**	Depending on state policy, electricity duty exemptions may also apply.

Franchise = partial shortcut

Taking a PSU/CPO franchise like BPCL, Tata Power, Statiq, or ChargeZone gives you access to some subsidies and financing through their government partnerships, plus brand, software, and maintenance. Trade-off: you give up a revenue-share / royalty, and lose some pricing control.

3 Business model: which one suits you?

Model	Investment	Effort / Control	Best for whom?
Self-owned (CAPEX)	Full (₹10–25 L)	High effort, full margin & control	Those who understand the market, long-term serious players
Franchise (FOCO) Franchise Owned, Company Operated	You: land + capital	Low hassle, lower margin	First-timers, those wanting passive income
Land lease to CPO	Zero (only land)	Zero effort, fixed rent/share	Those with land but no wish to invest

Franchise vs independent — honest take

Franchise sounds "easy" but **fees have risen sharply** recently. Buying the charger + payment software independently and listing on multiple discovery apps (Google Maps, PlugShare, Statiq) gives better margins + more control. A smart approach: learn with a franchise for your first station, then go independent.

4 Ideal locations (this is the real game)

Location decides profitability far more than charger type. The rule is simple: **high visibility + high dwell time = strong revenue.**

Best-performing spots:

- **Highway corridors between metros** — routes like Hyderabad–Bengaluru, Mumbai–Pune, Delhi–Jaipur
- **Petrol pump premises** — vehicles already stop here, a natural fit
- **Mall / shopping center parking** — long dwell time (shop while the car charges)
- **Tech parks & IT corridors** — higher density of EV owners
- **Hotels, resorts, railway stations, airport parking**

Counter-intuitive tip

A spot with moderate traffic but **long parking duration** outperforms a high-traffic, short-stay spot. Why? Charging takes time — the car needs a reason to stay. Look for a minimum of ~550 sq.ft (2 cars) of space.

Avoid this mistake

A DC fast charger in a dead-end lane = failure. The same charger next to a busy petrol pump / mall pays off within 18 months. If the location is wrong, no amount of good hardware saves it.

5 Unit economics & realistic profit

The business math is simple: buy electricity from the DISCOM at the **EV tariff** (₹5–6.5/unit), and sell it to EV owners with a service charge (typically **₹12–18/unit** at public stations). That margin — after fixed costs (rent, maintenance, DISCOM charges) — is your profit.

Item	Figure
Electricity cost (EV tariff)	₹5 – 6.5 / unit
Selling price to customer	₹12 – 18 / unit
One car full charge	~30 – 45 units
Revenue per DC charger (moderate use)	**₹30,000 – ₹1,00,000 / month**
Realistic break-even	18 – 36 months

Honest expectation setting

Saying "20 cars daily = guaranteed ₹1.5 lakh profit" is over-simplified. In the early months utilization is low (25% typical); as it rises (40%+) profit grows. Power bills + maintenance can eat up to **50–60% of revenue**. Realistically, one well-placed DC charger can yield **₹30k–1 lakh/month** profit — depending on location, uptime, and EV density.

To stabilise profit

A **monthly subscription tie-up** with fleet / cab operators (Ola, Uber, delivery) gives a steady base income in the early days, so you don't depend entirely on walk-in customers.

6 How to handle payments

No cash handling is needed — everything is digital and automated.

- **CMS software (Charging Management System):** connects the charger to an app + payment gateway. Options include Tata Power, Statiq, ChargeZone, or white-label software.
- **QR code + app payment:** the customer locates the station in an app, plugs in, and pays via UPI/card. Auto-billing once the session completes.
- **In the franchise model:** payment goes to the company, and each month they auto-transfer your profit margin **directly to your bank account**. Zero cash handling.
- **Discovery apps:** list on Google Maps, PlugShare, Statiq, ZEVpoint — so customers find your station via navigation.

7 Step-by-step setup (exact sequence)

1. **Location shortlist:** pick 3–5 spots — footfall, highway/commercial proximity, ~550 sq.ft parking. Negotiate a revenue-share lease.
2. **Decide model & charger:** AC vs DC, self vs franchise. Get quotes from 3 vendors (ABB, Delta, Exicom, Servotech) — BIS-certified, CCS2 connector.
3. **DISCOM connection (START EARLY):** apply at your local DISCOM (in Telangana, TSSPDCL) for a commercial meter + transformer + **EV tariff category**. Takes 4–12 weeks — this is the most common delay.
4. **Site prep:** concrete foundation, canopy, CCTV, lighting, signage. Fire Safety NOC + Electrical Inspector sign-off (mandatory before energizing).
5. **Software + registration:** connect the CMS, register on the EVSE (BEE) portal, ensure OCPP 2.0.1 compliance.
6. **Apply for subsidy + financing:** apply for state capital subsidy once the station is live. Look at schemes like SBI EV Mitra for financing.
7. **Go live:** list on Google Maps, PlugShare, ZEVpoint. Monitor utilization via the OCPP dashboard and adjust pricing/hours.

About licensing

EV charging is a **de-licensed activity** (Electricity Act, 2003) — no distribution license required. But you do need: DISCOM connection approval, Electrical Inspector certification, Fire Safety NOC, building/municipal permissions, and BIS-certified charger hardware.

Next step: check your area

This guide gives you the overview. Your specific state EV policy, the routes near you, and the exact subsidy numbers vary by area. If you're serious, first check your state EV policy + local DISCOM EV tariff, then get 2–3 CPO/franchise quotes.

If you have questions, comment **"EV"** — I'll DM you. If the DM doesn't arrive, the broadcast channel link is in my bio; check there (please follow first).

Disclaimer: This guide is general educational information only — not investment or financial advice. The numbers (investment, subsidy, profit) are approximate and as of 2026 — they vary by location, state policy, and market conditions. Subsidy schemes have deadlines and eligibility conditions; verify with official sources (state EV policy, DISCOM, PM E-DRIVE portal, franchise brand) before applying. Consult a qualified financial advisor / CA before any investment decision.